

This text, known in English as The Secret Glorious Play of the Supreme Horse, th

Toh 839 · Derge Kangyur

This text, known in English as The Secret Glorious Play of the Supreme Horse, the Unsurpassed Intention of All Tathāgatas (with a Sanskrit title reconstructed in the colophon and a Tibetan title rendered as De bzhin gshegs pa thams cad kyi dgongs pa bla na med pa gsang ba rta mchog rol pa'i rgyud chen po), is catalogued as Toh 839 in the Kangyur, placing it among the collection of tantric scriptures. It presents itself as a great tantra, a genre of esoteric Buddhist teaching concerned with advanced ritual, symbolic, and meditative instructions attributed to the enlightened intention of all buddhas. The surviving passage, drawn from its concluding chapter on protection, depicts a divine assembly being instructed on the virtues of faith and mutual loving-kindness among those who uphold and transmit this king of tantras. As the colophon indicates, this portion constitutes the close of the root text itself, marking the completion of a cycle of teaching centered on secrecy, divine play, and the protection of the doctrine among its devoted practitioners.

Delighting all therein,
he again instructed all the gods:
Those who, through the strength of faith,
uphold this king of tantras,
will also show loving-kindness toward others who hold it.

This completes the thirtieth chapter, on protection, from the great tantra called The Secret Glorious Play of the Supreme Horse of All Tathāgatas.

Here ends the root text of the great tantra The Secret Glorious Play of the Supreme Horse, the Unsurpassed Intention of All Tathāgatas.

Translator's Notes

- "Supreme Horse" (Tib. rta mchog) is an epithet for the deity Hayagrīva; the tantra's title could also be rendered "The Secret Glorious Play of Hayagrīva," but the literal "Supreme Horse" is kept here per the source text, since no specific glossary entry fixes this proper name.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.